



INDIA'S READY FOR SATCOM

TELECOM MINISTER
JYOTIRADITYA SCINDIA TALKS
STARLINK AND IMPORTANCE
OF SATCOM IN INDIA

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India is on the cusp of welcoming Elon Musk's Starlink internet service, as the government has officially confirmed that the satellite-based broadband provider has crossed two key regulatory milestones. Speaking exclusively to Digit, Minister of Communications Jyotiraditya Scindia offered a detailed breakdown of Starlink's licensing progress and what still remains before the company can begin its commercial operations.

During the chat, Scindia stated that Starlink has already been granted a Unified License (UL) in June, which

is a critical requirement to operate telecom services in India. It allows a service provider to offer a wide range of telecom services including internet access across the country. "Starlink has been given a UL (a Unified License) in June. They have received their IN-SPACe authorization in the month of July," Scindia said.

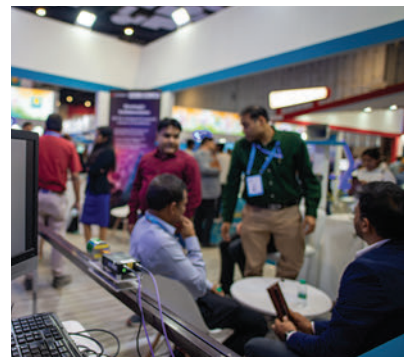
On asking about the formal launch timeline, he added that there are still four or five pending issues after which they can start the service.

"So they need to get their approval for their satcom gateways. They need to identify their points of presence. They need to get their spectrum. They need to get license approvals for their networking equipment that they're going to set up. And once they comply with all of those, they can certainly start business," he stated.

SATCOM is imperative

Speaking of the importance, Scindia stated that satcom is today's tech-

nology. He also mentioned India's evolving digital ecosystem and growing ambition to lead in advanced communication technologies.



"I think satcom is imperative for the country. Satcom is a technology that is no longer tomorrow's technology. It is today's technology. It's important for India, which has now transformed itself from being a follower of technology to a leader of technology, to make sure that we adopt state-of-the-art technologies in our country," he added.

